

Lesson 2.1 – Types of Pruning Tools

1. Bypass Pruners (Recommended)

Best for:

- Living branches
- Clean, precise cuts

How it works:

- Two blades pass by each other like scissors

Example

You are cutting a healthy guava branch:

- Using bypass pruners → smooth cut → heals quickly
- Using dull tool → crushed stem → disease risk

2. Anvil Pruners (Use with caution)

Best for:

- Dead wood

Why not for live branches?

- Crushes plant tissue instead of slicing

3. Pruning Saw

Best for:

- Thick branches (too large for pruners)

Example

Cutting a 2-inch mango branch:

- Pruners → difficult and unsafe
- Saw → smooth and controlled cut

4. Loppers

Best for:

- Medium-sized branches
- Extra leverage

Lesson 2.2 – Importance of Sharp Tools

Why Sharp Tools Matter

- Produce clean cuts

- Promote faster healing
- Reduce infection risk

What Happens with Dull Tools?

- Tears bark
- Leaves uneven wounds
- Increases disease entry

Demo: Sharp vs Dull Cut

Scenario:

You cut the same branch using two tools.

Tool Type Result

Sharp bypass pruner Smooth cut, clean surface

Dull pruner Crushed, jagged edges

Lesson 2.3 – Proper Cutting Technique

Steps for a Clean Cut

1. Identify the branch to remove
2. Position tool at a 45-degree angle
3. Cut in one smooth motion
4. Avoid twisting or forcing the cut

Example

Cutting a small citrus branch:

- Correct: quick, angled cut → heals fast
- Wrong: slow crushing cut → delays healing

Lesson 2.4 – Tool Safety Practices

Safety Guidelines

Always:

- Wear gloves
- Use eye protection
- Maintain stable footing

Never:

- Use damaged tools

- Cut above your head without control
- Work on a wet or unstable surface

Demo Scenario

Unsafe Practice:

- Standing on a slippery ladder
- Using a dull saw

→ High risk of injury

Safe Practice:

- Stable ladder
- Sharp tool
- Controlled cutting angle

Lesson 2.5 – Tool Maintenance

Cleaning Tools

After each use:

- Remove dirt and sap
- Wipe blades dry

Sharpening Tools

- Use a sharpening stone or file
- Maintain blade angle
- Test sharpness before use

Example

A farmer who sharpens tools regularly:

- Cuts faster
- Trees heal better
- Less effort required

Lesson 2.6 – Tool Sanitization

When to Sanitize

- Between trees
- When disease is suspected

Why?

- Prevents spreading infection

Demo: Sanitizing Tools

1. Prepare solution:

- o 70% alcohol OR bleach solution

2. Dip or wipe blade

3. Let dry before next cut

Example

If one tree has fungus:

- Unsanitized tool → spreads disease to all trees
- Sanitized tool → infection contained

Lesson 2.7 – Choosing the Right Tool (Decision Guide)

Quick Guide

Situation Tool

Small live branch Bypass pruner

Dead branch Anvil pruner

Thick branch Saw

Medium branch Loppers

Scenario-Based Example

You are pruning a mango tree:

- Thin shoots → bypass pruner
- Thick limb → pruning saw
- Dead wood → anvil pruner